

THE EQUITY EXPRESSION OF THE COPPER THESIS

The Wrong Warehouse

On Monday 17 August the spot price of copper on the London Metal Exchange traded as much as **\$545 a tonne above the three-month futures contract** — the widest such gap since the historic squeeze of 2021. Three-month futures reached \$14,396 a tonne intraday before settling back to \$14,179, closing in on the record above \$14,500 set in January. Inventories in the LME warehouse network have fallen by almost half since mid-May.

Every one of those facts is consistent with the structural copper shortage the mining industry has been forecasting for a decade. None of them is evidence of it. Total global copper inventory is not unusually low. It has simply moved to the United States, ahead of a tariff that has not been announced.

A reframe worth holding onto

The internal Wiki's copper page, built almost entirely on 13D Research, argues that the binding constraint is geological and multi-decade: ore grades have halved, exploration budgets have halved, and the gap between discovery and first production is ten to fifteen years. That view treats price spikes as noise around a rising floor — a floor set by the cost of building supply that does not yet exist, not by this quarter's warehouse receipts.

Held alongside this week's tape, the reframe is uncomfortable rather than confirming. If the thesis is right, the current squeeze is the wrong evidence for it.

Method. External prices, spreads, inventories and company figures are drawn from primary company releases and dated wire reporting, and are labelled with the date they refer to. Internal views come from the Heyokha research Wiki and are attributed to the named research provider; they are that provider's opinion, not a Heyokha forecast and not verified fact. Where internal and external accounts disagree, both are stated and the disagreement is left standing.

Consider a river town with a petrol station on each bank and a persistent rumour that a toll is about to be imposed on the bridge. Tanker drivers begin routing every load to the far side, to be on the right side of the toll before it lands. The near-bank station runs dry. Queues form. Motorists start paying a premium for fuel *this afternoon* rather than fuel on Thursday, and the price at that one pump spikes to levels nobody has seen in five years. Nothing whatsoever has happened to the world's supply of petrol. The fuel exists; it is on the wrong side of the river, held there by people who believe it will shortly be worth more there than here. Meanwhile — and quite separately — the refinery that feeds both stations has been running its equipment past design life for a decade, has not sunk a new still since the last downturn, and could not raise output by a fifth if it were paid to. Both things are true at once. The queue at the dry pump is real, and it tells almost nothing about the refinery. Copper is the fuel; the LME warehouse system is the near-bank station; the toll is a United States tariff that Washington has kept the market guessing about for seven weeks past its own deadline.

THE STORY IN 60 SECONDS

\$545/t

Peak premium of LME spot copper over the three-month contract on 17 August 2026 — the widest backwardation since the 2021 squeeze. Three-month futures traded as high as \$14,396/t that day before easing to \$14,179/t. *Bloomberg, 17 Aug 2026.*

54%

Copper's share of BHP's FY26 Underlying EBITDA — more than half the group for the first time, on more than US\$18bn from copper against ~US\$33bn for the group. *BHP full-year results, 18 Aug 2026.*

5.27 Mt

Chile's 2026 copper output forecast, cut for a second consecutive quarter — down 300kt on the prior estimate and far below the 5.6 Mt once expected. *Cochilco, 11 Aug 2026.*

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

Two separate stories arriving in the same price

The proximate cause of the August squeeze is a trade policy that does not yet exist. Refined copper cathode is currently exempt from the United States' Section 232 metals tariffs, but the exemption is under active review. The Commerce Department's deadline to deliver a recommendation to the President passed at the end of June; roughly seven weeks later no decision has been announced. The structure under discussion is phased — 15 per cent from January 2027, rising to 30 per cent from January 2028. Faced with a binary event of unknown timing, traders have done the rational thing and moved metal to the United States, where it would sit inside any future tariff wall rather than outside it.

The effect on the visible inventory that the rest of the world trades against has been severe. LME warehouse stocks stood at 389,425 tonnes in late May, 249,850 tonnes in late July, and 204,975 tonnes by mid-August — the lowest since February. Stocks fell for forty-two consecutive sessions, the longest unbroken run of declines since 2014, before ticking up marginally on 17 August. Because LME warehouses are the physical industry's supplier of last resort, and because metal on warrant is what settles expiring futures, a drawdown of that size lands directly on the front of the curve. Monday's fireworks came immediately before the third Wednesday of the month, the exchange's main liquidity date; shorts covering into that date bought cash and sold forward, and holders of metal, sitting on a lucrative arbitrage, declined to lend it.

The second story is genuinely about supply, and it is not new. Chile's copper commission cut the country's 2026 production forecast for a second straight quarter on 11 August, to 5.27 million tonnes, a fall of 2.6 per cent on the year, citing weak first-half output at Codelco's mines and at BHP's Escondida and Spence. Antofagasta cut its own 2026 guidance to 625,000–655,000 tonnes from 650,000–700,000 after July snow and rain halted Los Pelambres and the government declared a state of catastrophe in the Coquimbo Region. Ivanhoe narrowed its Kamoakakula guidance to 290,000–310,000 tonnes from a range topping out at 330,000. Southern Copper's mined output fell 3.5 per cent quarter on quarter, with a 12 per cent drop in Peru.

Those two stories point in the same direction this month, which is precisely why they are being read as one. They are not one. The first is a question about where metal is stored and will unwind the moment Washington rules either way. The second is a question about how much metal exists and will take a decade to answer.

THE ESSENTIAL DISTINCTION

A squeeze is a statement about the *location and timing* of metal. A deficit is a statement about its *quantity*. The two produce identical price action and opposite conclusions about what happens next: a squeeze resolves when the metal moves, and a deficit resolves only when a mine is built.

MECHANISM

What happens to one tonne of copper



Ore grade, exploration and TC/RC figures: internal Wiki, citing 13D Research (WILTW, 15 Jan 2026) — a research provider's analysis, not independently verified here. Warehouse, arbitrage and spread mechanics: Bloomberg reporting, 17 Aug 2026. Diagram is a stylised description of a single unit's path, not a model.



LME inventory and concentration: Bloomberg, 17 Aug 2026. Tariff structure and status: Congressional Research Service and wire reporting, Aug 2026. Glencore: Half-Year Production Report, 29 Jul 2026.

THE CENTRAL COMPARISON

What miners received, and what Chile expects next



Realised prices from Freeport-McMoRan and Teck Resources Q2 2026 releases (both 23 Jul 2026); forecasts from Cochilco, 11 Aug 2026. Bars are illustrative and scaled to the highest value shown; they are not a forecast and not investment advice.

The bars carry the whole ambiguity. Realised prices rose roughly 36 per cent year on year at Freeport and 40 per cent at Teck — an extraordinary earnings tailwind that arrived without either company producing meaningfully better ore. And the agency closest to a third of world supply, in the same document in which it cut Chilean output for the second quarter running, forecasts an average price next year *below* this year's. Chile's own copper commission is simultaneously the most credible witness for the supply problem and a forecaster of lower prices.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

Treat the copper price as two prices added together: a *scarcity rent*, earned by whoever owns metal in the right jurisdiction this week, and a *replacement cost*, set by what it takes to build the next mine. Only the second is durable. The first can vanish in a single press release from Washington.

THE SHIFT

What has actually changed

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
Copper became a major miner's main business	Copper contributed more than half of BHP's Underlying EBITDA for the first time — over US\$18bn of ~US\$33bn, on ~2 Mt of production for a second year (18 Aug 2026).	It validates a decade of capital reallocation and makes copper growth self-funding. It also means the largest miner's earnings now swing on one metal's price, at the top of that price's range.
Earnings are coming from price, not volume	Southern Copper posted record Q2 net income of \$1.67bn (+71.6%) on sales of \$4.29bn (+40.6%) while mined output fell 3.5% quarter on quarter, with Peru down 12%.	Operating leverage to price is precisely what a shortage thesis predicts. It is also what makes the earnings fragile: the volume line is going the wrong way.
Inventory has become a location problem	LME stocks halved from 389,425 t (late May) to 204,975 t (mid-Aug); total global inventory is not unusually low but is concentrated in the US ahead of a possible tariff.	Visible scarcity is real for anyone who needs metal on the LME. It is also reversible: a tariff decision either way removes the incentive to hoard metal on one side of an ocean.
Supply misses are operational, not only geological	Antofagasta cut 2026 guidance after July snow closed Los Pelambres; Chile's cut is attributed to weak H1 at Codelco, Escondida and Spence; Cochilco expects a rebound to 5.55 Mt in 2027.	Weather and mine sequencing are recoverable, which weakens the structural reading. But repeated recoverable misses across many operators is itself evidence that the asset base is stretched.
Large new supply is genuinely arriving	Freeport's Grasberg Block Cave doubled from 34,000 t/day in April to 69,000 t/day in June, targeting ~65% of district capacity in H2 2026, 80% by mid-2027 and near-full by end-2027.	It is the clearest counterweight to the deficit narrative on a two-year view. It is also a single asset in a single jurisdiction, recovering from a 2025 mud-rush incident.
Traders, not only miners, are monetising the dislocation	Glencore guided to H1 2026 Marketing Adjusted EBIT of approximately \$3.3bn, against \$1.4bn in the comparable prior period.	Trading profits of that size are a signature of physical dislocation and arbitrage — evidence that a material part of this year's copper story is about moving metal rather than mining more of it.

Bull and bear, stated fairly

The bull case

- **The geology is not arguable.** Average ore grade fell from about 1.4% (2010) to roughly 0.65% (2024), more than doubling the rock moved per tonne of metal. Exploration spending is down close to half in real terms since 2012. *Internal Wiki, citing 13D Research.*
- **Replacement cost sets a rising floor.** BHP has estimated roughly \$23,000 per tonne of annual capacity to build new supply; Teck's Quebrada Blanca came in at \$29,000/t and Antofagasta's Centinela at \$30,000/t. Prices must clear that to incentivise the next mine. *Internal Wiki, citing 13D.*
- **The largest producer is voting with capital.** BHP has a pipeline across Chile, Australia and Argentina that it says can lift copper output by around 40% by FY35, and has approved US\$0.5bn of pre-commitment funding for a new Escondida concentrator ahead of a final decision in CY27–28.
- **Demand growth is broad, not narrow.** BHP puts copper demand at about 34 Mtpa today rising above 50 Mtpa by 2050, driven by Chinese grid investment, US electrification and Indian industrialisation — not by any single end-market.
- **Smelting is starved, not idle by choice.** Treatment and refining charges collapsed and turned negative; the internal Wiki cites 14.3% of global smelting capacity inactive as of January 2026. Chinese smelters short of concentrate must buy refined metal, adding to the squeeze.
- **Substitution is bounded.** Aluminium carries roughly 60% of copper's conductivity, requiring thicker conductors and more insulation — a poor trade where space and heat are constrained. *Internal Wiki, citing 13D.*

The bear case

- **This month's signal is a tariff trade.** Bloomberg's own account of the squeeze is explicit that total global inventories are not particularly low and that Chinese demand is not seen as particularly strong. The tightness is where the metal sits, not how much exists.
- **Chile's own commission forecasts lower prices.** Cochilco raised its 2026 average to \$5.95/lb but left 2027 at \$5.10/lb, and expects Chilean output to rebound to 5.55 Mt next year. The most informed supply forecaster is not extrapolating the squeeze.
- **Large tonnage is ramping now.** Grasberg's block cave doubled daily output between April and June and targets near-full capacity by end-2027. That is a material, dated, near-term supply response.
- **The misses are weather and sequencing.** Los Pelambres was stopped by July snow; Chile's shortfall is attributed to a weak first half at named assets. Recoverable disruptions have been read as structural scarcity.
- **The shortage's loudest advocate cannot fill his own mine.** Kamoakakula produced 64,328 t in Q2 2026, down from 71,417 t in Q1, with guidance narrowed downward and the operation running near 60% of design capacity. Execution risk is not the same as geological scarcity.
- **Earnings quality is deteriorating beneath record headlines.** Southern Copper's record profit came on falling volumes; Antofagasta's and Ivanhoe's guidance both moved down. Peak margins on shrinking output is a familiar late-cycle pattern.

The bear column here was not lifted from the Wiki. The internal page's bear case runs to three short paragraphs — recession, thriftiness, and a surprise wave of new mines — and its most recent review date is 24 June 2026, before any of this month's events. The counterweight above was therefore assembled from external reporting and from tensions visible inside the producers' own results: record profits on falling volumes, guidance cut for weather, and a large block cave doubling its output while the industry describes a shortage.

WHERE THE ACCOUNTS DIVERGE

Three causes, one price

The internal Wiki, following 13D's reading of an S&P Global study, holds that electrification accounts for roughly half of projected demand growth while AI and data centres account for only about 10 per cent — an explicit argument that a hyperscaler capex slowdown would matter less than the market assumes. External commentary this month runs the opposite way: the CLSA note of 14 August foregrounds data-centre intensity (up to 50,000 tonnes of copper per hyperscale facility, roughly two miles of cabling per AI rack), and wire coverage has attributed August's record prices to AI and grid demand. Bloomberg's reporting on the same week attributes the actual squeeze to neither, pointing instead at tariff-driven flows to the United States. Three credible accounts, three different causes, one price. This edition does not resolve them.

A smaller divergence is worth naming because it undermines the arithmetic everyone is quoting. The internal page cites S&P Global at 28 Mt of current demand rising to 42 Mt by 2040. BHP's chief executive said on 18 August that demand is about 34 Mtpa today, heading above 50 Mtpa by 2050. Robert Friedland, quoted in the 14 August CLSA note, works from 30 Mt consumed annually. Those are three different figures for the size of the market as it stands today, from three sources with every reason to know. Deficit forecasts built on them inherit that spread before any assumption about the future is made.

SIGNALS

What to watch from here

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
The Section 232 decision on refined copper	Washington rules either to tariff refined cathode or to leave the exemption in place. Nothing has been announced roughly seven weeks past the Commerce deadline.	It is the single event that would end the incentive to hold metal in the United States. Whichever way it lands, the location premium has a resolution date.
LME cash-to-three-month spread	The \$545/t backwardation of 17 August narrowing back toward contango, or persisting past the third-Wednesday date.	A spread that collapses once the settlement date passes was a positioning artefact. One that persists into September is closer to genuine physical scarcity.
Metal emerging from China	Chinese warehouses have historically released cathode into short-term pinches. Whether that happens now is an open question.	Chinese outflows would confirm the metal exists and is merely mispositioned. Their absence would strengthen the scarcity reading considerably.
Grasberg's ramp against its stated schedule	Freeport targets ~65% of district capacity in H2 2026, 80% by mid-2027, near-full by end-2027.	This is the largest single tranche of near-term new supply. Delivery on schedule is the most concrete refutation of a 2027 deficit; slippage is the reverse.
Chilean H2 recovery at El Teniente and Rajo Inca	Cochilco's rebound to 5.55 Mt in 2027 rests on named Codelco assets performing in the second half.	If the rebound does not appear, the "recoverable disruption" reading of 2026 fails and the structural case strengthens materially.
Treatment and refining charges	What smelters are paid to turn concentrate into cathode. These collapsed and turned negative.	TC/RCs are the cleanest available read on whether concentrate is genuinely short, because they are set by the physical trade rather than by financial positioning.

EXPRESSIONS

Three postures, not one answer

Own the replacement cost

Large diversified producers with funded growth pipelines express the view that the durable component of the price is what it costs to build the next mine. **The cost:** earnings are now heavily levered to one metal at the top of its range, and the growth arrives in the mid-2030s while the share price marks to this quarter.

Own the dislocation

Trading and marketing businesses monetise the gap between where metal is and where it is wanted, irrespective of whether more is mined. **The cost:** the earnings are episodic by construction, and the same tariff resolution that ends the squeeze ends the arbitrage that produced them.

Own the ramp, not the theme

Single-asset growth stories priced on execution rather than on commodity narrative offer exposure that pays off if tonnes actually arrive. **The cost:** concentrated operational and jurisdictional risk, and — as Kamoā-Kakula's quarter shows — a ramp that stalls hurts regardless of what copper does.

The companies named below and above are illustrative examples used to show how the theme appears in listed equities. They are NOT recommendations. Nothing in this document is investment advice, and no view is expressed on the suitability of any security for any purpose.

BHP

Copper 54% of FY26 EBITDA · 18 Aug 2026
BHP Group — diversified major, ASX/LSE/NYSE

Reported FY26 Underlying EBITDA of approximately US\$33bn, up 27%, and underlying profit of US\$13.2bn, up 30%. Copper generated more than US\$18bn — 54% of group EBITDA and the largest contributor for the first time — on roughly 2 Mt of production for a second consecutive year. Net debt fell below US\$9bn; the final dividend of 99 US cents is the largest in four years. Management describes copper growth as self-funding, with a pipeline it says could add around 40% to output by FY35.

WATCH NEXT

The Escondida concentrator final investment decision, guided to CY27–28, after US\$0.5bn of pre-commitment funding.

FCX

\$6.17/lb realised Q2 · 23 Jul 2026
Freeport-McMoRan — copper pure-play, NYSE

Q2 2026 net income attributable to common stock of \$984m, or \$0.68 per share; adjusted \$1.1bn, or \$0.74, on revenue of \$7.03bn. Consolidated copper sales of 710 million pounds at unit net cash costs of \$1.97/lb excluding idle and restoration costs tied to the 2025 mud rush. Realised copper of \$6.17/lb against \$4.54/lb a year earlier. The Grasberg Block Cave doubled from 34,000 t/day in April to 69,000 t/day in June.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the district holds ~65% of capacity through H2 2026 en route to 80% by mid-2027.

SCCO

\$1.67bn net income Q2 2026
Southern Copper — Peru and Mexico, NYSE

Record second-quarter net income of \$1.67bn, up 71.6%, on net sales of \$4.29bn, up 40.6%. Mined copper production fell 3.5% quarter on quarter, a 12.0% decline in Peru outweighing a 3.2% gain in Mexico; silver, zinc and molybdenum output all fell. The result is the clearest single illustration of this edition's tension: a record profit driven almost entirely by price rather than volume, at a company producing less metal than it did three months earlier.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Peruvian volumes stabilise, or whether record margins continue to rest on a shrinking production base.

TECK

+25% copper YoY Q2 · 23 Jul 2026
Teck Resources — QB2 operator, TSX/NYSE

Copper production rose approximately 25% year on year to 135,900 tonnes, with Quebrada Blanca at 55,800 tonnes — a third consecutive quarter of stable operations after a difficult ramp. Profit attributable to shareholders of C\$854m against C\$206m a year earlier; adjusted EBITDA up 204% to about C\$2.2bn at a record 61% margin. Realised copper of approximately US\$6.05/lb against US\$4.32/lb. Full-year guidance is unchanged at roughly 455,000–530,000 tonnes.

WATCH NEXT

QB2 holding stable through a fourth quarter, and progress on the announced combination with Anglo American.

ANTO

Guidance cut H1 · Aug 2026
Antofagasta — Chilean pure-play, LSE

H1 2026 group copper production of 285,000 tonnes, down 9% year on year on lower output at Los Pelambres and Centinela, with EBITDA up 27% on price. Full-year guidance was cut to 625,000–655,000 tonnes from 650,000–700,000 after July rain and snow forced Los Pelambres to halt and Chile declared a state of catastrophe in the Coquimbo Region. Net cash cost fell about 8% to roughly \$1.10/lb on by-product credits; 2026 capital expenditure is guided at \$3.4bn.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the H2 recovery at Los Pelambres arrives, testing the "recoverable weather" reading of Chile's shortfall.

GLEN

~\$3.3bn marketing EBIT H1 2026
Glencore — producer and trader, LSE

H1 2026 copper production rose 15% to 397,000 tonnes on better African volumes and grades and stronger grades at Antamina, with full-year guidance held at 810,000–870,000 tonnes despite completing the Kidd disposal on 1 June. Separately, the group guided to half-year Marketing Adjusted EBIT of approximately \$3.3bn against \$1.4bn in the comparable period. Cobalt fell 46% on export quotas and zinc 21% on closures and grades.

WATCH NEXT

Whether marketing earnings normalise once the tariff question resolves and the arbitrage that produced them closes.

The bottom line

What was repriced this month was not the world's stock of copper. It was the option value of holding metal inside a tariff wall that may or may not be built, expressed through the one market — LME warrants — where the drawdown is visible to everybody. That is a real economic event with real winners, and it explains a backwardation of \$545 a tonne, a seven-week rally, and Glencore guiding to marketing profits more than double the prior period. It does not, on its own, explain anything about 2030.

The evidence beneath it is genuinely mixed, and it would be dishonest to tidy that away. Ore grades really have halved and exploration really has not recovered; equally, Grasberg is doubling output on schedule, Chile's own commission expects both a production rebound and a lower average price next year, and the loudest advocate of imminent shortage is running his flagship mine near 60 per cent of design. The reasonable inference is that the structural case and the tactical squeeze have been read as a single piece of evidence when they are two, and that the equities have been marked on the second while the argument was made about the first. The next test is a specific one with a date attached: a Section 232 ruling on refined copper, and what the cash-to-three-month spread does in the fortnight after it lands.

Editorial note. This document is educational commentary prepared for internal use at Heyokha Brothers. It is not investment advice, not a recommendation, and not an offer or solicitation to buy or sell any security. Companies are named solely to illustrate how a theme appears in listed equities; no view is expressed or implied on their suitability for any investor. External figures are reported with the date to which they refer and are drawn from company releases and dated reporting; prices and spreads move and may be stale by the time this is read. Views drawn from the internal research Wiki are the opinions of the named research providers, reproduced as views rather than as verified facts or forecasts, and are not endorsed here. Where internal and external accounts conflict, the conflict is stated and deliberately left unresolved. Figures that could not be verified against a primary or dated secondary source were omitted rather than estimated.

Sources and update notes

(a) Internal. The principal internal source is the Wiki theme page **Copper** (slug *copper*; created 23 June 2026; last reviewed **24 June 2026**; 7,392 words; status active; tickers BHP, TECK, FCX, SCCO). Sections used: Thesis; Mechanism — why it holds; What would change it; the bull-case subsections; the three bear-case subsections; Key players & instruments; Companies; "Year-end 2025: structural deficit data intensifies"; "February 2026: CSPT smelting cut"; "April 2026: all-time weekly closing high, GYX breakout, and sulfuric acid crisis"; "August 2026"; and "August 2026: Friedland's 18-years-equals-10,000-years math, and the Bernstein deficit". Provider issues relied upon, via that page: **13D Research WILTW, 11 Dec 2025, 18 Dec 2025 and 15 Jan 2026** (S&P Global supply-peak study, ore-grade decline, exploration budgets, Wood Mackenzie and JP Morgan deficit forecasts, new-mine capex per tonne, aluminium substitution limits, Friedland's framing); **13D WILTW, 19 Feb 2026** (CSPT smelting cut, inactive smelting capacity, negative TC/RCs); **13D WILTW, 2 Apr, 19 Apr and 30 Apr 2026** (13D Copper Index performance, all-time weekly closing high, sulfuric acid crisis); **13D WATMTU, 5 Apr 2026 and 9 Aug 2026** (COPX technical framing; Copper Index +17.9% for the week to 9 Aug); **13D WILTW, 11 Jul 2024** (days-of-usage inventory framing); and **CLSA Bits & Pieces, 14 Aug 2026** (Friedland's copper arithmetic; the Bernstein 2027 shortfall; S&P Global data-centre intensity figures). The Wiki source-summary page for the CLSA note was read in full. The 13D WILTW of 13 Aug 2026 and Greed & Fear of 13 Aug 2026 were reviewed at index level for topic scoring only.

(b) Limitation on the internal view. The Copper page is close to a single-provider document. Of the thirty-six source issues listed in its frontmatter, thirty-five are 13D Research (WILTW and WATMTU); the sole non-13D input is the CLSA note of 14 August 2026, which is itself explicitly flagged by its publisher as sales commentary rather than analyst research, and which quotes an interested party — Robert Friedland, a copper mine operator — as its principal authority on copper scarcity. The page therefore reflects one house's structural-scarcity worldview with limited internal contradiction, and its bear case runs to three short paragraphs against many pages of bull material. It was last reviewed on 24 June 2026, which is before the July guidance cuts, before Cochilco's 11 August revision, before BHP's 18 August results, and before the entire August squeeze. Nothing on the page has been independently verified by this edition, and the page's own conclusions are reproduced as a provider's view.

(c) External sources. (1) **Bloomberg via Mining.com, 17 Aug 2026** — LME spot traded as much as \$545/t over three-month; widest backwardation since the 2021 squeeze; three-month futures as high as \$14,396/t, trading \$14,179/t at 16:09 London; stockpiles just above 200,000 t, lowest since February, down almost half since mid-May; 42 consecutive sessions of decline, longest since 2014; explicit note that total global inventories are not particularly low but concentrated in the US, and that Chinese demand is not seen as particularly strong; White House silence roughly seven weeks after the Commerce recommendation deadline. (2) **Wire reporting, Aug 2026** — LME stocks of 204,975 t versus 249,850 t in late July and 389,425 t in late May; January 2026 peak above \$14,500/t. (3) **Congressional Research Service and Section 232 reporting, 2026** — refined cathode, anodes, ores, concentrates, mattes and scrap currently exempt and under review; phased structure under discussion of 15% from January 2027 rising to 30% from January 2028. (4) **Cochilco, 11 Aug 2026** — Chile's 2026 output cut for a second consecutive quarter to 5.27 Mt, -2.6% year on year and 300kt below the prior estimate, against 5.6 Mt once expected; weakness at Codelco, Escondida and Spence; 2027 rebound forecast to 5.55 Mt on El Teniente and Rajo Inca; 2026 average price forecast raised to \$5.95/lb,

2027 maintained at \$5.10/lb. (5) **BHP full-year results for the year ended 30 June 2026, released 18 Aug 2026** — Underlying EBITDA ~US\$33bn (+27%); underlying profit US\$13.2bn (+30%); copper more than US\$18bn and 54% of group Underlying EBITDA, the largest contributor for the first time; ~2 Mt copper for a second year; net debt below US\$9bn; final dividend 99 US cents, largest in four years; pipeline described as potentially lifting copper output by around 40% by FY35; US\$0.5bn Escondida pre-commitment ahead of an FID in CY27–28; copper demand described as ~34 Mtpa today rising above 50 Mtpa by 2050; Jansen Stage 1 84% complete. (6) **Freeport-McMoRan Q2 2026 release, 23 Jul 2026** — net income \$984m / \$0.68 per share; adjusted \$1.1bn / \$0.74; revenue \$7.03bn; copper sales 710 million lbs; unit net cash costs \$1.97/lb excluding idle and restoration costs from the 2025 mud rush; realised copper \$6.17/lb versus \$4.54/lb; Grasberg Block Cave 34,000 t/day in April to 69,000 t/day in June; district targets of ~65% of capacity in H2 2026, 80% by mid-2027, near-full by end-2027. (7) **Teck Resources Q2 2026 release, 23 Jul 2026** — copper production 135,900 t, +25% year on year; QB 55,800 t versus 52,700 t; profit attributable C\$854m versus C\$206m; adjusted EBITDA ~C\$2.2bn, +204%, at a record 61% margin; realised copper ~US\$6.05/lb versus US\$4.32/lb; full-year guidance ~455,000–530,000 t. (8) **Antofagasta H1 2026 results, Aug 2026** — H1 copper 285,000 t, –9%; full-year guidance cut to 625,000–655,000 t from 650,000–700,000 t after July rain and snow halted Los Pelambres amid a declared state of catastrophe in Coquimbo; net cash cost ~\$1.10/lb, –8%; 2026 capex guidance \$3.4bn. (9) **Southern Copper Q2 2026 results** — record net income \$1.67bn, +71.6%; net sales \$4.29bn, +40.6%; mined copper 230,662 t, –3.5% quarter on quarter, Peru –12.0%, Mexico +3.2%. (10) **Glencore Half-Year Production Report, 29 Jul 2026** — copper production +15% to 397,000 t; full-year guidance held at 810,000–870,000 t after the Kidd disposal completed 1 June; guidance to half-year Marketing Adjusted EBIT of approximately \$3.3bn versus \$1.4bn; cobalt –46%, zinc –21%. (11) **Ivanhoe Mines Q2 2026 disclosures** — Kamoa-Kakula produced 64,328 t in Q2 versus 71,417 t in Q1; 2026 guidance narrowed to 290,000–310,000 t from 290,000–330,000 t; operation described at roughly 60% of design capacity.

(d) Editorial choices in this automated run. Topic selection followed the standing method: every Wiki source published since 29 July 2026 was scored by recency, with additional weight where an entity appeared in a source's title. On that scoring, gold ranked first, AI capex second, US Treasuries third — but Treasuries are not a theme-type page and so were ineligible, and AI capex was covered in the edition of 4 August. **Gold was skipped as a matter of editorial judgement rather than by strict rule:** the 5 August edition covered Gold Miners, and while "Gold" is a distinct theme page and not literally on the cooldown list, running it a fortnight later would have repeated substantially the same material. Copper was the highest-scoring remaining eligible theme and carried the strongest hot signal — it is a headline subject of the newest source in the Wiki, the CLSA note of 14 August. **Two tool failures should be recorded.** First, the remote-devices bridge to the user's *HB Wiki Learning* desktop folder was unavailable in this run, so the archive of past editions could not be read and the 30-day cooldown set could not be verified. Only two prior editions are known with confidence — 4 August, AI Capex, and 5 August, Gold Miners — and any other topic used in the past thirty days would not have been caught by this check. Second, one Wiki call failed with a lost server connection and was not retried; the affected section, "Key players & instruments", was substituted with the adjacent "Companies" section, which carries the same content. Direct market-data access was unavailable by design, so all prices, spreads and inventory figures in this edition come from dated wire reporting rather than from a live feed, and are stated as of the date reported rather than as of this morning.